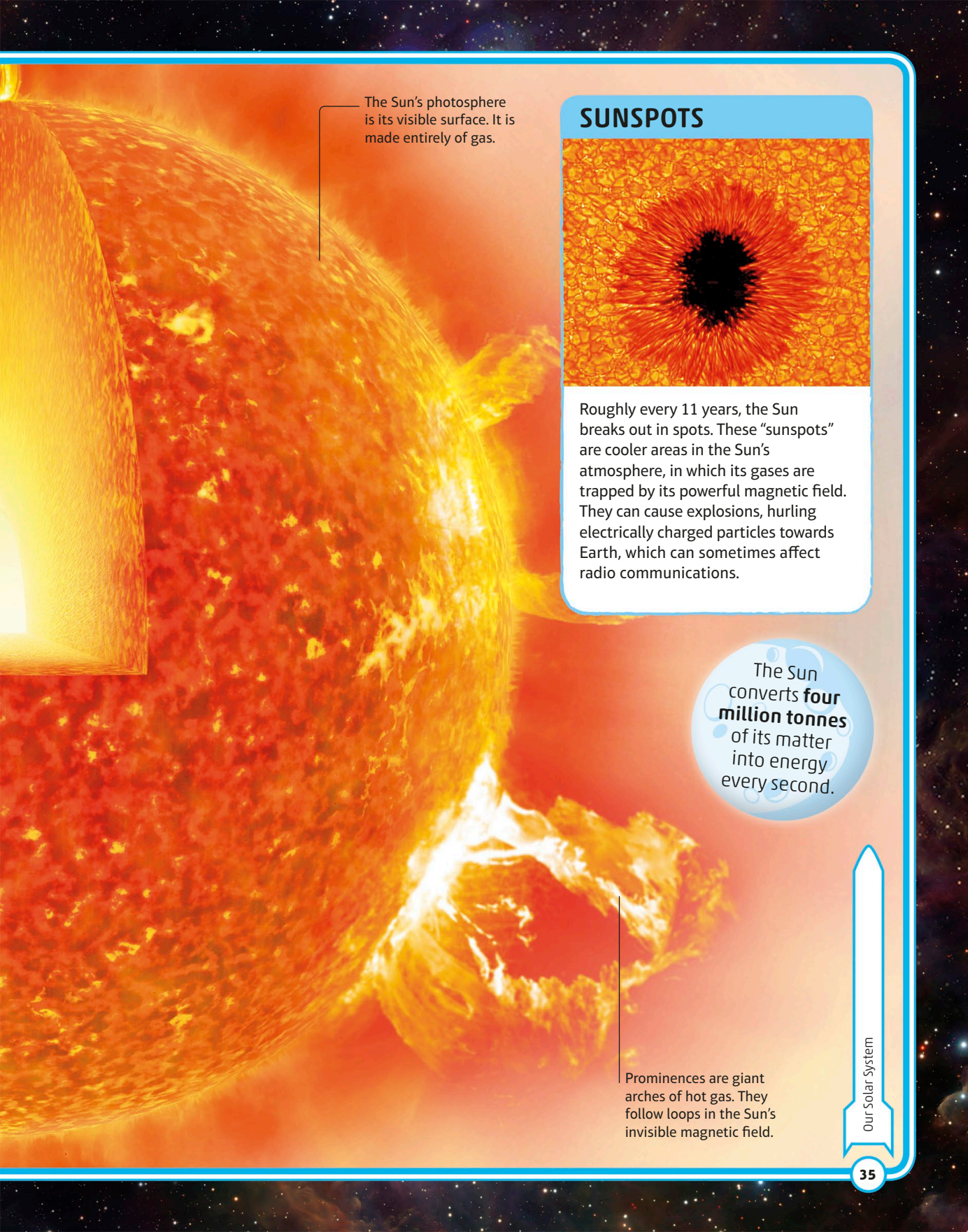
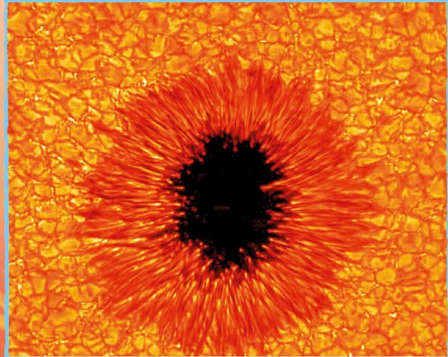




The Sun's photosphere is its visible surface. It is made entirely of gas.

SUNSPOTS



Roughly every 11 years, the Sun breaks out in spots. These “sunspots” are cooler areas in the Sun’s atmosphere, in which its gases are trapped by its powerful magnetic field. They can cause explosions, hurling electrically charged particles towards Earth, which can sometimes affect radio communications.

The Sun converts **four million tonnes** of its matter into energy every second.

Prominences are giant arches of hot gas. They follow loops in the Sun’s invisible magnetic field.